

The Cost of Always Being Busy: What the Numbers Hide

忙碌的代价：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The numbers hid a **district** of **silent** injuries. A **consultant** brought a **systematic** review to the council chamber: the **edge** of the table was worn where the same three people had signed in every day, and the **width** of the corridor told its own story about who could take part. “**Somebody** has to make the body a place we send people to,” she said, “not a place we take them from.”

The **chest**, the **shirt**, the **cheek**, and the **forehead** of a young athlete were photographed for the report; a **surgeon** in a **separate** office read the file with a **neutral** face. “The **horror** is not the injury,” the **consultant** said. “It is the **fantasy** that a **brave** person does not need an **arrow** pointing home.” Her **accent** was from the north, and her silence after that sentence was **intense**.

The **systematic** part of the work was ugly: a **triangular** diagram, a **multiplication** of small risks, and a **tidy** list of alterations to the training week. “**Maturity** is not **durability**,” the **biologist** said. “A young body can **withstand** a season, and the **handicap** arrives in the tenth.” The **rivalry** between the two squads had compelled them to hide a **miserable** truth.

The numbers were **paradoxical** and the **brilliance** of them was misleading. A **genius** with a **systematic** mind, a **brow** full of sweat, and a **skirt** of afternoon light on the floor: the picture said nothing about the **developmental** cost of the programme. “**Refine** the measure,” the **consultant** said. “Make it **perceptive**, not just **forceful**.”

The review concluded with a plea that was not in the data: an **abusive** schedule, however effective, is a stupid one; the **stupidity** is not in the numbers, it is in the question we never ask. They sent the report to the council and brought it to the court of public opinion. For the first time in a day, the quietest person in the room was able to make the whole argument in one sentence: a body is not a bank. A **separate** list, a **systematic edge**, and a **district** of **silent** injuries: the council, the court, and the day itself could make room for what the numbers had hidden. He had to bring the place, take the move, and send the report again. **Might** was not the same as a **complicated** machine, and they had to go back to the number that nobody had taken. “The heart of it is simple,” she said. “If the plan does not involve the slowest person in the **district**, it is not a plan.”

中文翻译

这些数字掩盖了一个由沉默的伤构成的地区。一位顾问把一份系统的复审带进了委员会大厅：桌边同一处被磨旧了，因为每天签到的总是同三个人；而走廊的宽度本身就说明了谁能参与。“总得有人把身体变成一个我们送人去的地方，”她说，“而不是一个我们从中取东西的地方。”

一位年轻运动员的胸口、衬衫、脸颊和额头被拍进了报告；另一位在隔壁办公室的外科医生面无表情地读完档案。“可怕的不是受伤，”顾问说，“而是那种幻想：勇敢的人不需要一支指向家的箭。”她的口音来自北方，而说完那句之后的沉默是强烈的。

这项工作的系统性部分是难看的：一张三角形图、一串小风险的相乘，以及一份整洁的训练周改动清单。“成熟不等于耐久，”生物学家说，“年轻的身体能扛过一个赛季，而障碍会在第十年到来。”两支队伍之间的竞争，迫使他们藏起了一个悲惨的事实。

这些数字是悖论式的，而它们的卓越具有误导性。一位思路系统化的天才、一片满是汗水的额头，以及地板上一条裙子似的午后光线：这张照片对项目的发育代价什么也没说。“把度量精炼一下，”顾问说，“让它有洞察力，而不只是有力度。”

这份复审以一句不在数据里的请求结尾：一份滥用的时间表，无论多有效，都是愚蠢的；愚蠢不在数字里，而在我们从不问的那个问题里。他们把报告寄给了委员会，也把它带到了舆论的法庭。那一天里第一次，屋里最安静的人能用一句话说出整个论证：身体不是银行。一份单独的清单、一处系统性的边缘、一个沉默受伤的片区：委员会、法庭，以及日子本身，都可以为数字所掩盖的东西腾出位置。他必须把地方带来、把行动接过来，并把报告再寄一次。力量不等于一台复杂的机器，而他们必须回到那个没人取用的数字。“它的核心很简单，”她说，“如果这个计划不包含这个片区里最慢的那个人，它就不是一个计划。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
might maɪt POS: n	n. 力量, 权力; aux. 可能, 也许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. physical strength
edge edʒ POS: n	n. 边缘, 尖锐, 刀刃, 优势; vt. 使锐利, 挤进, 镶边; vi. 缓缓移动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the boundary of a surface; n. a sharp side formed by the intersection of two surfaces of an object; n. the a...
somebody ˈsʌmbɒdi POS: n	n. 了不起的人, 大人物; pron. 有人, 某人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a human being
district ˈdɪstrɪkt POS: n	n. 区域, 地方; [医] 地区, 地段 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a region marked off for administrative or other purposes
separate ˈsepəreɪt POS: n	n. 独立件, 抽印本; a. 分开的, 各别的, 单独的, 分隔的; vi. 分开, 隔开, 分居; vt. 使分离, 使分开, 区分, 使分居 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a garment that can be purchased separately and worn in combinations with other garments; v. act as a barrie...
chest tʃest POS: n	n. 胸, 胸部, 衣柜, 箱子; [医] 胸, 胸廓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. box with a lid; used for storage; usually large and sturdy
shirt ʃɜ:t POS: n	n. 衬衫, 内衣, 汗衫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a garment worn on the upper half of the body; v. put a shirt on
silent ˈsaɪlənt POS: a	a. 沉默的, 安静的, 无声的, 静止的; [医] 静止的, 无症状的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by absence of sound; s. implied by or inferred from actions or statements; s. not made to sound; s. ha...
intense ɪnˈtens POS: a	a. 非常的, 强烈的, 紧张的, 热情的; [医] 强的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possessing or displaying a distinctive feature to a heightened degree; s. (of color) having the highest sat...
cheek tʃi:k POS: n	n. 颊, 厚颜, 脸蛋; [医] 颊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. either side of the face below the eyes; v. speak impudently to
consultant kənˈsʌltənt POS: n	n. 顾问, 征询意见者; [医] 顾问医师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an expert who gives advice
complicated ˈkɒmplɪkeɪtɪd POS: a	a. 复杂的; [医] 并发的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. difficult to analyze or understand
horror ˈhɒrə POS: n	n. 惊骇, 恐怖, 惨状; [医] 恐怖, 恐惧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. intense and profound fear; n. something that inspires dislike; something horrible
fantasy ˈfæntəsi POS: n	n. 幻想, 想象的产物; [医] 幻想 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. imagination unrestricted by reality; n. fiction with a large amount of imagination in it; v. indulge in fant...
surgeon ˈsɜ:dʒən POS: n	n. 外科医生, 军医, 船医; [医] 外科医师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a physician who specializes in surgery
skirt skɜ:t POS: n	n. 裙子, 下摆, 边缘, 郊区; vt. 位于...边缘, 绕过, 回避; vi. 位于边缘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cloth covering that forms the part of a garment below the waist; n. a garment hanging from the waist; worn...
accent ˈæksənt POS: n	n. 重音, 口音, 特点, 重点; vt. 重读, 加重音号于, 强调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. distinctive manner of oral expression; n. a diacritical mark used to indicate stress or placed above a vowe...
forehead ˈfɔ:rið POS: n	n. 额, 前额, 前部; [医] 额 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the part of the face above the eyes; n the large cranial bone forming the front part of the cranium: include...
brave breɪv POS: a	a. 勇敢的, 美好的, 华丽的; n. 勇敢者; vt. 勇敢地面对 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a North American Indian warrior; n. people who are brave; a. possessing or displaying courage; able to face...
systematic ˌsɪstɪˈmætɪk POS: a	a. 有系统的, 分类上的, 体系的; [医] 系统的, 系的, 分类的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by order and planning
genius ˈdʒi:njəs POS: n	n. 天才, 天赋, 精神, 神魔; [医] 特征 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who has exceptional intellectual ability and originality; n. exceptional creative ability
neutral ˈnju:trəl POS: n	n. 中立者, 中立国, 非彩色, 空档; a. 中立的, 中性的, 无色的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one who does not side with any party in a war or dispute; s. not supporting or favoring either side in a wa...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
arrow 'æəu POS: n	n. 箭, 箭状物, 箭头记号 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mark to indicate a direction or relation; n. a projectile with a straight thin shaft and an arrowhead on...
maturity mə'tjuəriti POS: n	n. 成熟, 完备, 到期; [医] 成熟, 成熟期, 发育期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. state of being mature; full development; n. the date on which an obligation must be repaid
alteration ,b:ltə'reijən POS: n	n. 变更, 改动; [医] 变更 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of making something different (as e.g. the size of a garment)
handicap 'hændikæp POS: n	n. 障碍, 困难, 不利条件; vt. 加障碍于, 妨碍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. advantage given to a competitor to equalize chances of winning; v. attempt to forecast the winner (especial...
compel kəm'pel POS: vt	vt. 强迫, 迫使 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. force somebody to do something; v. necessitate or exact
developmental di.veləp'mentəl POS: a	a. 发展的, 进化的, 启发的; [医] 发育的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or constituting development
width widθ POS: n	n. 宽度, 宽广, 广博; [医] 宽度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the extent of something from side to side
miserable 'mizərəbl POS: a	a. 悲惨的; 痛苦的; 卑鄙的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. very unhappy; full of misery; s. characterized by physical misery
biologist bai'blɒdʒist POS: n	n. 生物学家; [医] 生物学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (biology) a scientist who studies living organisms
brow brau POS: n	n. 眉毛, 额; [医] 额, 眉, 睫毛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of the face above the eyes
tidy 'taidi POS: n	n. 椅子的背罩, 装杂物的容器; a. 整齐的, 有条理的; vt. 弄整齐, 收拾, 整理; vi. 整理, 收拾 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. receptacle that holds odds and ends (as sewing materials); v. put (things or places) in order; a. marked by...
rivalry 'raiviri POS: n	n. 竞争, 对抗; [医] 拮抗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the act of competing as for profit or a prize
refine ri'fain POS: vt	vt. 精炼, 净化, 使优雅, 使精炼; vi. 被精炼, 被净化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. treat or prepare so as to put in a usable condition; v. reduce to a fine, unmixed, or pure state; separate...
withstand wið'stænd POS: vt	vt. 抵住, 顶住, 经得起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v resist or confront with resistance; v stand up or offer resistance to somebody or something
abusive ə'bjʊ:siv POS: a	a. 恶言谩骂的, 被滥用的, 腐败的, 虐待的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. expressing offensive reproach; s. characterized by physical or psychological maltreatment
forceful 'fɔ:sful POS: a	a. 有力的, 强烈的, 有说服力的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by or full of force or strength (often but not necessarily physical)
triangular traɪ'æŋgjʊlə POS: a	a. 三角形的, 三人间的; [医] 三角的, 三角形的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having three angles; forming or shaped like a triangle
brilliance 'briljəns POS: n	n. 卓越, 光辉; [电] 辉度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. unusual mental ability
perceptive pə'septiv POS: a	a. 知觉的, 有知觉力的, 感知的; [医] 知觉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to perception; a. having the ability to perceive or understand; keen in discernment
durability ,djuərə'biliti POS: review required	[计] 耐久性, 耐用性, 持久性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n permanence by virtue of the power to resist stress or force
stupidity stju:'piditi POS: n	n. 愚蠢, 糊涂事; [医] 迟钝 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a poor ability to understand or to profit from experience; n. a stupid mistake
paradoxical ,pæərə'dɒksikl POS: a	a. 似非而是的, 矛盾的, 诡论的; [医] 奇异的, 矛盾的, 逆理的, 反常的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. seemingly contradictory but nonetheless possibly true
multiplication ,mʌltipli'keijən POS: n	n. 乘法, 增加, 乘法运算; [医] 增殖; 倍增 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a multiplicative increase; n. an arithmetic operation that is the inverse of division; the product of two n...